Glossary

baton – a thin stick used by a conductor of a music orchestra

drawl – slow, lazy way of talking

tangles – a confused mass, twisted

grimace – expression of disgust on a person's face

accompaniments – music played to support an instrument, voice or group

contralto – the lowest female voice

forte – a musical tone played loudly

crescendo – a gradual increase in the loudness of a sound

aisle – a passage between rows of seats

fiancé – a man to whom one is engaged to be married

doleful - sorrowful

A. Based on your understanding of the story, answer the following questions in about 30 – 50 words each.

1. What was the knife that Miss Meadows carried with her?

2. What kind of relationship existed between Miss Meadows and the Science Mistress?

3. Why was Miss Meadows upset and dejected?

4. How would Miss Meadows usually treat Mary? How did her behaviour towards the girl change that day?

5. Why had Miss Meadows chosen 'A Lament' as the lesson that particular day?

6. What brought agony to the girls during the music lessons?

7. Bring out the substance of Basil's letter to Miss Meadows.

8. Why did Miss Wyatt summon Miss Meadows to her room?

9. How did Miss Meadows express her joy, when she returned to the music class?

10. Briefly explain the cause of Miss Meadows' joy at the end.



Vocabulary

Note the following words from the story. They all refer to different ways of walking. Find out their meanings and use each of them in meaningful sentences of your own. Refer a thesaurus and add a few more to the list.

a) trod
b) fluttered
c) hurried
d) skipped
e) strode
f) sped

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